

**Google inactive account manager**

Decide what happens to your Google account and associated data after you become inactive. <https://digit.in/jun20-56>

**Aftervault**

A dead man's switch with compartmentalised vaults to give access to various docs and info. <https://digit.in/jun20-57>

Jacking out of the matrix

Take control of your digital legacy when you get bluescreened

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hat happens to all your accounts on various services after you die? We have addressed the

question before in the December 2018 of Digit, which had estimates on the number of such accounts (hundreds of millions on Facebook), as well as the ethics of how such accounts are used. This article will focus on what you can do to secure and get in control of your own digital legacy. Without these steps, the accounts just stagnate for a couple of years, and then the data gets purged after a period of inactivity. Most subscription services will continue to run for a year, before they are paused. Some can however, extend indefinitely, and your family members will have to take the trouble of informing the bank and getting the credit or debit card deactivated. You can however, save them the trouble by taking some steps now, and making sure that you, as well as your near and dear ones, are ready for the eventuality of your demise.

GOOGLE

For most of us, Google is the service that most of our accounts are linked to. Google provides very powerful granular controls that let you decide what you want to do with your account after your death. Before we go into that though, it makes sense to link as many services as possible to Google. If you are using only your mobile number for services such as Twitter or Instagram, it is a good idea to make sure that they are linked to your Google account as well. In Facebook, the option to link a Google account is available in general settings, where you can add an email address. Note that a single email address can only be linked to a single Facebook account. In Instagram, the option is available under Edit profile. Unlike Facebook, Instagram allows a user to link the same email address as well as phone number to multiple accounts. In Twitter, the option is available in Settings > Account > Login and security. These are most of the major services that let you sign up without giving an email address.

Now to choose what your Google account does after your death, go to Inactive Account Manager, and change when Google should start taking the actions that you have specified. The minimum is 3 months, and the maximum is 18 months. Then you have to add in a phone number if you have already not done so for that particular account. There will also be an option to specify a recovery email address, which should usually already be set up. In the next step, you can add email addresses that allow people to access the data in other Google services. This includes Calendar, Chrome, Drive, Keep, Photos and your YouTube channel. These options are flexible enough for you to decide which people get access to which of your services. This means that you can share your Photos with family, and access to a YouTube channel with colleagues. From here, you can also set an autoreply, that either informs people that the account is no longer active, or that they should stop bugging you because you are dead. Finally, you can choose to delete all